

Malavika Susan

Senior Product Designer (UI/UX)

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Professional summary

Senior Product Designer with 10+ years across enterprise SaaS, data security, and generative AI, translating ambiguous, high-stakes problems into evidence-backed product direction. Moved into a newly formed AI squad based on a leadership track record, now owning major roadmap initiatives end-to-end; from discovery through implementation, including building self-programmed AI tools and turning ambiguous systems into structured and usable products at scale.

Work experience

IBM Sustainability - Product Designer, Asset Lifecycle Management

Maximo Manage & watsonx.ai | Jan 2026 - present

Selected for an internal move to a newly formed AI squad based on a leadership track record in Data Security.

Summarization capability for 9.3 Maximo AI Service (Role: Design owner)

- Drove the vision, validation and delivery of an initial summarization feature request into a broader AI-powered insight generation capability, synthesizing findings from 24 voice-of-customer interviews.
- Created a custom schema-enforced, MCP-integrated reusable AI research agent to systematically identify cross-persona patterns and information needs from customer interviews.
- Led the 9.3 usability validation study (5 participants from 2 companies), using progressive disclosure concepts to evaluate AI-generated insights across Maximo roles. Developed a role-based information needs framework (5 categories) that directly informed OOTB AI summary configurations and roadmap decisions.
- Self-coded a business-focused AI summary generator; a working software tool replacing a highly technical engineering-built prototype adopted by Platform teams to accelerate delivery of 50+ backlog use cases, enabling custom configuration of scenario-specific summaries and recommendations through a reusable framework for test data and insight signal generation.

Intelligent context & clarification for 9.3 Maximo Assistant (Role: Design owner)

- Authored a two-part context-awareness and clarification specification for Maximo Assistant 9.3, covering 15 use-case categories with structured behaviour rules based on value assessment and creating developer spike stories, sequencing delivery to validate these cases.
- Delivered a highly scalable confidence-driven decision framework for high-priority ambiguity patterns (Missing Entity & Multiple Matches scenarios), reframing confidence as emergent from context rather than fixed to an utterance.
- Crafted 5 resolution tiers by friction/interaction cost and a recoverability spectrum classifying scenarios as easy, medium, or hard to resolve using a pass or fail criteria evaluation model.

9.2 Maximo AI Assistant (Role: Design owner and Contributor)

- Drove high-volume QA contribution across assistant capability within a team-wide tracking system, contributing to a 242% increase in tracked findings release-over-release (113 to 390), with 68% mapped to actionable tickets.
- Led 9.2 usability validation of the AI assistant's agentic capabilities (7+ new capabilities validated), defining methodology and success metrics from scratch; recruited an 8-user panel across 3 enterprise companies and delivered an executive playback that set next-release priorities (6.8/7 productivity impact rating).
- Built a two-stage AI-assisted synthesis workflow that cut research synthesis time 10x, now adopted by other designers on the team.

IBM Data Security - UX Lead, Risk Management

Guardium Data Protection & watsonx.ai | Mar 2024 - Jan 2026

Promoted from UX Designer to UX Lead.

- Led design for Threat Analytics and Vulnerability Management, defining risk, trust and behavioural analytics journeys including dashboard modernization, configuration and AI-assisted investigation workflows aligned to Carbon Design System and Graphite.
- Facilitated 4 cross-functional workshops aligning PM and engineering on business scenarios; led usability studies achieving 77%+ task completion across key analytics flows.
- Launched AI-assisted threat management on watsonx.ai, reducing investigation effort 12x through conversational query translation, policy generation, and threat summarization; drove a 64.9% feature conversion rate via Amplitude-instrumented analytics, with the summarization feature adopted by 68% of users over a comparable policy-generation flow.

Chainlink - Product designer (Contract)

Chainlink Console | July 2023 - March 2024

- Simplified complex blockchain and smart-contract workflows for Console, Chainlink's unified on-chain services dashboard, within a 3-person design pod; owned trigger configuration, data-fetch steps, template-based flow creation, and a live Solidity code preview.
- Owned end-to-end delivery of Console's alerts/notifications system (condition-based rules, environment thresholds, delivery configuration) and in-product Search feature.
- Reframed the entire Resource Hub, a developer knowledge base spanning 7+ content types, product documentation and learning resources, with consistent filtering and card patterns.
- Led design of a unified, adaptive navigation system replacing fragmented per-product headers across ~20+ surfaces, cutting new-header build effort by ~10x.

Hypersonix.ai - Product designer

July 2021 - July 2022

- Launched App Studio, a demand forecasting tool covering the full pipeline as a user-facing experience; from data engineering (POS and consumer data source selection, attribute creation) through data science configuration (forecast methodology, seasonality, date ranges) to final outputs, structured as a multi-tab flow.
- Led design of the front-end experience for Ask Jarvis, a natural-language search interface letting business users query enterprise data conversationally, sitting on top of two backend systems (an Insight Engine for trends/anomalies/comparisons, and a Query Engine for relational/NLP-based search), owning core logic, keyword association model, and interaction design.
- Helped establish Sonic Design System, Hypersonix's 0-to-1 design system, creating foundational components and patterns that scaled across the company's enterprise AI and analytics products.
- Contributed to Profit-GPT, a BI dashboard giving retail enterprises actionable insight into profitability, sales trends, and anomalies, contributing to designing insight card structures and Fusion Charts integration, scaling relationships between metrics through a network style layout.

Aphelia Innovations - UX designer

July 2020 - July 2021

- Progressed from intern to full-time in 2 months; owned 0-to-100 design for two financial-domain products; converted a trading startup's manual Excel workflows into monitoring software (Roamacumen) and built a loan-model-ratio calculator for PCBB's clientele.
- Designed DigiDonor (QR-based charity app) and contributed onboarding design for Sevaro, a WCAG 2.0-compliant telehealth app for senior citizens.

Architecture Experience

2016 - 2020

- Associate Design Lead, Atelier D'Arts & Architecture, Bangalore.
- Architecture Intern, Talati & Panthaky Associates, Mumbai and Flying Elephant Studio, Bangalore.
- Developed a foundation in systems thinking, spatial design, and complex problem-solving that continues to inform product and UX design practice.

Education

- **Interaction & Experience Design (MSc)**, University of Limerick, Ireland
- **Bachelor's in Architecture (B.Arch.)**, Holy Crescent College of Architecture, India

Tools and skills

- **Strategy & leadership:** Product strategy, roadmap influence, discovery frameworks, evidence-based decision-making, cross-functional facilitation, stakeholder alignment, systems thinking
- **Research:** Usability testing, Moderated research, Synthesis frameworks, JTBD, Competitive analysis
- **AI/UX:** Conversational and agentic UX design, dialogue/state design (Resolution frameworks, Confidence-based clarification), AI evaluation & QA methodology, Prompt engineering
- **Independent AI tool building:** BOB (AI-assisted, prompt-driven tool development), Figma Make, Git collaboration
- **Visual & Systems Design:** Figma, Framer, Design Systems (Carbon, Sonic), Prototyping
- **Technical Fluency:** HTML, CSS, JS (React basics), GitHub (essential training), MCP integration
- **Compliance & Trust:** GDPR, WCAG 2.1, ISO 27001, Security-by-design principles (SBDP)